

UGC CREATOR BUSINESS OS

QUICK-START GUIDE

Price, pitch, and invoice brand deals with confidence.

1. Make a copy first

Open the file in Google Sheets (upload it, then “File → Save as Google Sheets”) or Excel. Never edit the original download — keep it as a backup.

2. Start with the Rate Calculator, even before your first deal

Go to the **Rate Calculator** tab and set your base hourly-equivalent rate in the blue cell. Not sure what to put? Start at \$40–\$60/hour if you're new, \$75–\$125/hour once you have 5+ completed deals and testimonials. This number should go up over time — revisit it monthly.

3. Every brand conversation goes in the Pipeline — immediately

The moment a brand DMs you, replies to your pitch, or you find one worth reaching out to: add a row to **Brand Deal Pipeline**. Move the Stage dropdown forward as the conversation progresses. This does two things: nothing falls through the cracks, and you build a real record of your win rate over time (visible on the Dashboard).

4. Never quote a rate without checking Usage Rights first

Before you answer “how much do you charge,” ask the brand: *“Is this for your organic page only, or do you plan to run it as a paid ad? If so, for how long, and on which accounts?”* Their answer tells you which row to use in the **Usage Rights Cheat Sheet**, which tells you the multiplier to use in the Rate Calculator. This one habit is worth more than everything else in this guide combined.

5. Every closed deal gets an invoice row

When a deal hits “Closed-Won” in the Pipeline, create the matching row in **Invoices**. Mark it Paid once you're actually paid — this is what feeds your real revenue numbers on the Dashboard, so keep it current.

6. Check the Dashboard weekly, not daily

Once a week, look at: Active Pipeline Value (how much is in motion), Win Rate (are you closing what you pitch), and Total Unpaid Invoices (are you chasing money that's overdue). These three numbers tell you whether the business is healthy.

Rate Negotiation Script

When a brand offers a rate first:

“Thanks for sending that over! Based on [deliverable type] with [usage rights they mentioned], my rate for this scope is \$[your calculator number]. Happy to talk through the details.”

When a brand wants to expand usage after the fact:

“Totally happy to extend usage — since that changes from [original terms] to [new terms], the rate for that would be \$[recalculated number]. Want me to send an updated agreement?”

When a brand pushes back on price:

“I get it — if the budget's tighter, we could scale the usage rights down to [organic only / shorter window] to hit a lower number, or keep the usage as-is at the quoted rate. Which works better for you?”

Usage Rights Contract Clause Checklist

Before you sign anything, the agreement should state, in writing:

- ☐ Exact deliverables (number of videos/photos, length, format)
- ☐ Usage rights tier and duration (organic / whitelisted 30-90 days / paid ads 6mo / buyout) — match this to what you were actually paid for
- ☐ Which accounts can post/run the content (yours, theirs, both)
- ☐ Revision limit (1–2 rounds is standard; unlimited revisions is a red flag)
- ☐ Payment terms and due date (net 15 or net 30, not “after it goes live”)
- ☐ What happens if usage extends past the agreed window (should trigger a new rate, not silent free extension)

If a brand won't put these in writing, that itself is information.